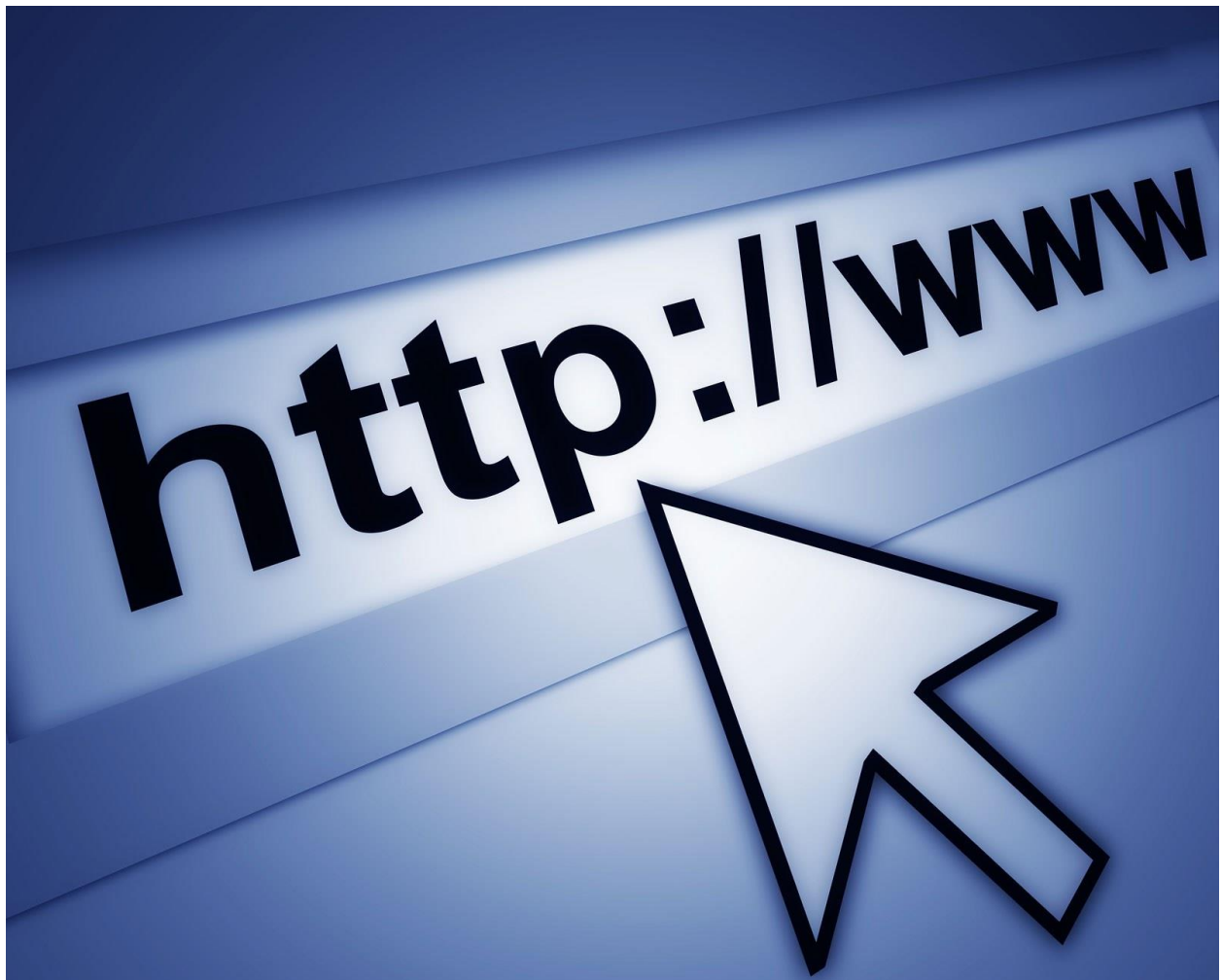




Intro-Entertainment Industry ~ Week 13

[One More Artist Site](#)



- [Tessa Evelyn](#)

Gaining Access in General



- Talk to people at auditions, interviews
- Take ANY job (volunteer or paid) at theaters or companies you want to be part of
- Attend lots of auditions; take lots of interviews
 - It's okay to take lots of auditions, but very bad to go to a callback if you don't intend to accept a role (same is true of interviewing for a position—if you get to the second interview, you should be willing to take the job)
- Research theaters, production companies, and other entertainment companies to find out where you would fit the best
- Avoid hanging out with complainers, cynics, gossips, negative people
- Consider NOT starting in LA or NYC – it's easier to get started in solid regional markets (easier to get your union cards, too)

Gaining Access to Agents and Casting Directors



- Best way: recommendation from a friend, teacher, casting director, director
- Slowest way: mailing the big manila envelope with your resume, headshot, and cover letter
- Perform well in a show
- Send them a query letter
- Take a class with them (but beware of scams)
- Postcards (inviting them to a show, following up after meeting, etc.)—brand identification
 - Always include your picture and contact info somewhere on the postcard

How to Recognize Rip-Off Classes



- Very expensive
- Very short
- Extremely large class size
- Promise of work as a result of the class
- Splashy advertising
- Lack of requirements to get in
- Promising publication on a website they claim “everyone” uses
- Pushing their own photographer (at a price)
- Look up the instructor on www.IMDB.com
- Ultimately: take the class to learn, not to impress someone

Self-Sabotage



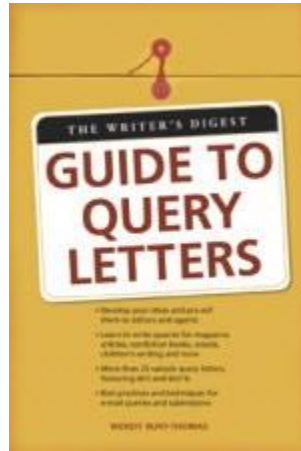
- Being late
- Not working on the sides or copy
- Not reading the play/screenplay if it is available
- Not dressing appropriately
- Bringing your bad mood into the casting room
- Bringing lot of props to use
- Wearing strong perfume
- Bringing your pet along
- Being defensive in the audition when asked to make adjustments
- Not filling out the appropriate paperwork
- Cursing your agent in the lobby, loudly, when the sides or copy you got from them was wrong
- Having liquor on your breath
- Passing out clever self-promotional materials to the auditors
- Shaking hands with everyone in the room
- Telling the director that the casting director who is present in the room didn't tell them anything about the role
- Being inflexible when screw ups happen (and they always do—we're all human)

Remember



- Manners and kindness are essential at every level of the entertainment business

Query Letters



- Picture and contact info, including agent if applicable, should be the header
- Well-crafted
- Specifically to a particular theatre, casting director, or agency (usually not to directors)
- Solve a problem
- Research who you're writing to
- Don't start with "I"
- Spellcheck
- Make sure you spell their organization and their name correctly
- Tell them specifically why you're writing
- Tell them how you might be helpful to their agency or project
- If you have met them, remind them where and when
- Include information about your current situation (just graduated, just moved to LA, etc.)
- Include some compliment about their work
- **Craft your own query letter—small groups**

Casting Directors



- **Theatrical Casting** – film and television casting
- **Commercial Casting** – casting for commercials
- **Real People Casting** – real people on the street (not actors)
- **Legit Casting** – casting for the stage
- Casting Directors do not select the cast (directors do that)
- Casting Directors do present a short list of the best actors available for the job
- Don't call them AGENTS
- They are allied to the project, not the actor
- They are not part of the unions, but they spend a lot of time negotiating with them
- Directors typically only want to see about 3 actors for a film or TV role; commercial clients want to see as many actors as possible
- Belong to Casting Society of America (CSA) – theatrical casting directors

Personal Managers



- People who manage an actor's career
- Cannot legally negotiate contracts
- Not licensed through the unions
- Actor's advocate—do the phone calls, research, promotion
- Charge 10-20 percent of the actor's income
- Usually manage a small number of actors over a long period of time
- Attempt to shape careers
- Longer contracts, harder to get out of
- Legit managers never charge money until the actor is paid
- The good ones belong to the National Conference of Personal Managers, Inc (NCOPM) or the Talent Managers Association (TMA): www.Talentmanagers.org or www.NCOPM.com

Agents



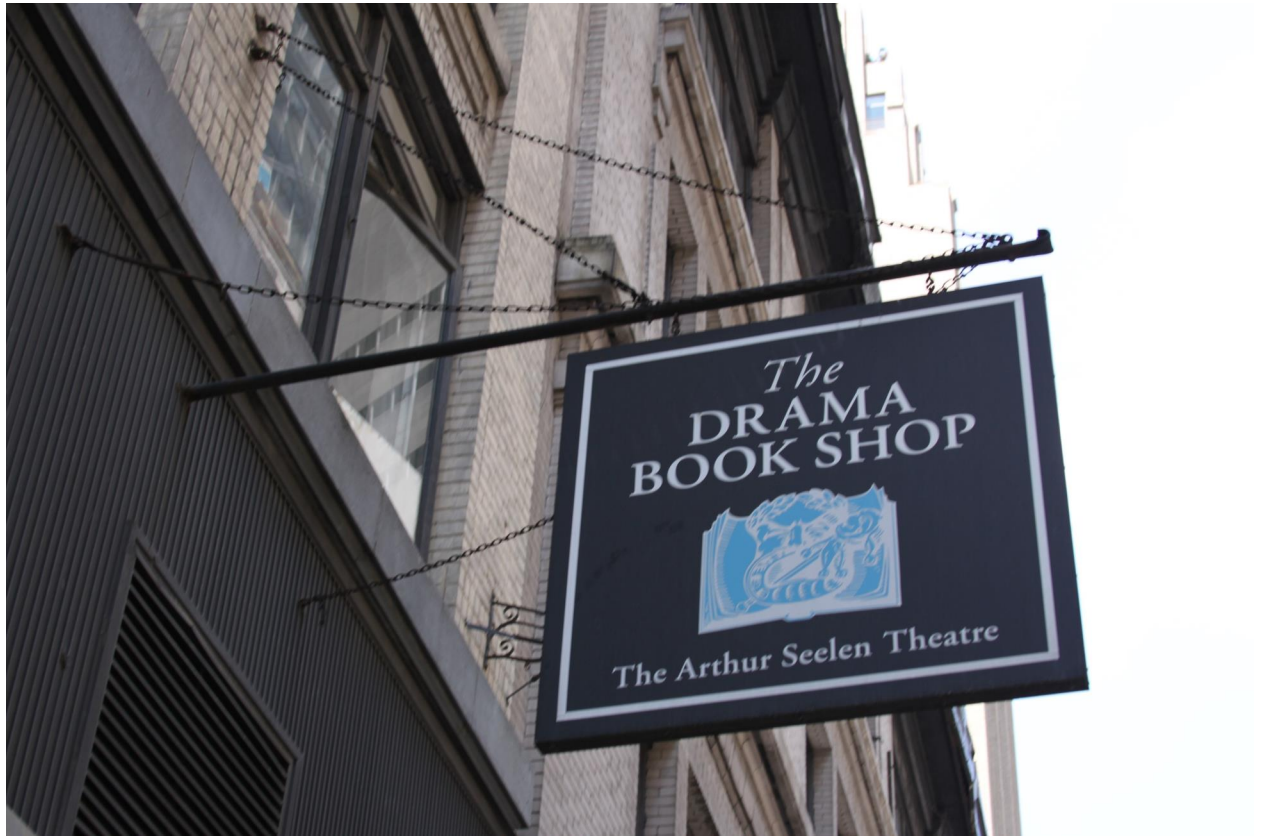
- Work with a larger number of actors—success based on volume
- Either the actor or the agent can leave the contract if no work is landed within 90 days
- Take a standard 10 percent of each project

Extras



- Extras in movies or TV may only make \$50 - \$150 a day—not part of the union
- Extras in commercials—paid better—the first 26 extras in a commercial must be SAG-AFTRA

Random Tip: The Drama Bookshop



Great place for anything theatre, film, TV--plays, scripts, in-store readings, dialect material, business items

[Drama Bookshop Website](#)

This used to be a very fun place to hang out when in NYC. It was in danger of closing, but recently Lin-Manuel Miranda and friends purchased it. Look for it to reopen sometime soon!